FINNBOT: GUIDE FOR NEW USERS

Every choice you'll make when joining Finnbot, what each option costs, and how to get what it needs.
Prices and features as of October 26, 2026.

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0. WHAT FINNBOT DOES

Finnbot sends you a stock-market email (the "digest") on trading days, and optionally Telegram messages when something about your holdings needs attention.

The digest can include:

- **Markets and macro:** graded market signals (trend, mood, breadth, rates, the dollar, oil) and the day's top macro news.
- **Swing ideas:** US stocks set up for a move over the next few weeks, with an entry, stop, and target.
- **Long-term ideas:** US businesses that look worth owning for years at today's price.
- **Your portfolio (if you connect holdings):** its value, the day's change, unrealized gain or loss, which positions need attention, upcoming earnings, a review of risks across the whole portfolio (with a chart of how it's spread across sectors), and a card for each holding (its price, your average purchase price, gain or loss, signal, reasoning, and news).
- **A daily price chart for every US stock,** on its card (holdings and ideas alike).

Each holding gets one of five signals from an AI model:

Signal	Description
Buy more	The stock has pulled back and the data suggests it will recover: a time to add.
Hold	Healthy. Give it time.
Risky	Something looks off and needs watching. Selling to be safe may make sense.
Profit sell	It has risen, but the indicators say the run may turn down soon.
Urgent sell	A specific, time-sensitive problem. The only signal that sends a Telegram alert.

These signals are AI-generated opinions based on market data and news. They are not financial advice, and the same stock can occasionally get a different signal on two runs with the same data. Always make your own decisions. Sections 8 and 9 explain how the ideas are found

and how your holdings are assessed.

Who pays for what:

- The ideas, the market signals, and the macro news are shared by everyone. Andres covers them.
- Anything about YOUR holdings (the AI review of each stock, its news, and the portfolio review) runs on YOUR OWN API keys, so those providers bill you directly:
    - Anthropic (the reviews): about $1-2 a month for 10-20 holdings with both digests, plus a few cents to a dollar or so for the watchdog.
    - Google (the news, optional): about $0.25-0.55 a month for 10-20 holdings with both digests. It needs billing turned on for your Gemini key: Google's free tier doesn't include the web search the news uses.
    - Section 3.10 has the full table.
- An ideas-only user (section 2.3) pays nothing.

1. THE BASICS (EVERYONE)

1.1 Your name

What it is: the name Finnbot greets you with ("Good morning, Steven"). It's also the label Andres uses for your settings, so it must be different from every other user's.
Format: your first name, letters only (a hyphen is fine).

1.2 Your email address

What it is: where the digest is sent.
Recommendation: a Gmail address, read in the Gmail app. The email is designed for a phone, and its dropdowns and "jump to this stock" taps work in Gmail once you allow them (1.4). Other email apps show a standard version of the same content.

1.3 Which digests you want

There are two digests each trading day (a day the US or Canadian stock market is open). Times are US Eastern time (ET, New York's time). Each takes about 20-30 minutes to build, so it arrives a little after it starts.

- **Pre-Market digest:** Starts at 7:00 ET, before the US market opens at 9:30 ET. Covers the

previous session's moves, and live moves on markets that are already open (for example London).
- **Post-Market digest:** Starts at 4:10 PM ET, 10 minutes after the US market closes. Covers the full day that just ended.

Your options:

- **Both:** Pros: the most up to date; morning plan and evening wrap-up. Cons: about twice the AI cost for your holdings (a bit less with news on, since the evening reuses the morning's news; section 3.10).
- **Pre-Market only:** Pros: arrives before the market opens, so you can plan the day. Cons: US figures are from the previous day.
- **Post-Market only:** Pros: the day's final results. Cons: arrives in the evening in North America, and overnight in Asia-Pacific (for example about 4:40 AM in Perth).
- **Neither:** Only useful with holdings and Telegram, to get the watchdog's alerts without emails.

Ideas only (2.3) costs you nothing either way, so both is the natural choice there.

Converting ET to your time (approximate; daylight saving shifts these by an hour for part of the year): Toronto and New York: same. Bogota: 1 hour earlier for most of the year. London: 5 hours later. Perth: 12 hours later (13 in the northern winter). Sydney: 14-16 hours later.

1.4 Make the email's dropdowns work in Gmail (dynamic email)

What it is: the digest is mostly dropdowns (each section, each stock), so you can open only what you want. Gmail shows these working dropdowns ("dynamic email") only for senders you have allowed. Without this step, Gmail shows a plainer version with everything already open.

Who it's for: Gmail users. Other email apps always show the plainer version.

Steps (once, on a computer; the Gmail app has no such setting, but it follows your account's choice):

1. Open Gmail in a web browser, signed in to the account the digest goes to.
2. Click the gear icon at the top right, then "See all settings".
3. On the General tab, scroll to "Dynamic email" and tick "Enable dynamic email".
4. Click "Developer settings" next to it, add Finnbot's sending address: finnbot107@gmail.com and click OK.
5. Scroll to the bottom of the General tab and click "Save Changes".

After this, the next digest opens with its dropdowns working, in the Gmail app too. Digests older than 30 days go back to the plainer version (a Gmail rule).

Cost: none.

2. THE MAIN DECISION: HOW FINNBOT SEES YOUR HOLDINGS

Choose one of three options. This choice decides which of the later sections apply to you. In the sign-up form they read:

- "Link automatically to brokerage, RECOMMENDED (through SnapTrade)" = option A
- "Manually update a Google Sheet" = option B
- "No holdings, just suggestions to buy (free)" = option C

Option	Effort to set up	Stays up to date	Costs you
A. SnapTrade (recommended)	Medium	Automatically	AI costs (section 3.10)
B. Google Sheets	Low-medium	Only when you edit it	AI costs (section 3.10)
C. Ideas only	None	(no holdings)	Nothing

You can switch later (section 5).

2.1 Option A: SnapTrade (link your brokerage; recommended)

What it is: SnapTrade is a service that connects to your brokerage account (for example Questrade or Wealthsimple) and lets Finnbot READ your positions: what you own, how many shares, in which accounts, and what you paid. Finnbot never places trades.

Pros:

- Automatic: your holdings are always current, including trades you just made.
- Every account at the brokerage is included (TFSA, RRSP, margin, ...), with the names your broker uses.
- Your average cost comes from your broker, so no typing and no typos.

Cons:

- More steps to set up (below).
- A third party (SnapTrade) gets read access to your brokerage account.

- Brokerage connections occasionally expire and need you to log in again through SnapTrade. Finnbot tells you when this happens (it also tells you if an account hasn't synced in 4 days).
- Not every brokerage is supported. Check SnapTrade's list of supported brokerages first.
- If your broker doesn't report what you paid for a position, its gain or loss shows as unknown.

IMPORTANT, READ BEFORE CHOOSING SNAPTRADE:

SnapTrade's own guidance says a Personal API key "must not be distributed in an app or shared with other people", and that it "can access your brokerage data and may be able to trade where trading is enabled". Finnbot only ever reads your positions, but sending the key to Andres means trusting him with that access. Choose read-only access when SnapTrade offers it (step 3), and if you'd rather not share that access at all, Google Sheets (option B) avoids the issue entirely, because nothing is connected to your brokerage.

Steps (from SnapTrade's documentation; the dashboard's exact wording may differ):

6. Go to SnapTrade and sign up for a free Personal account.
7. Turn on two-factor authentication for your SnapTrade account (SnapTrade requires it for Personal API keys, and it protects your brokerage link).
8. In the SnapTrade dashboard, connect your brokerage: choose your broker and log in to it in SnapTrade's secure connection window. If you're offered read-only access, choose it: Finnbot never needs to trade.
9. Open the dashboard's API Key page and create your Personal API key. You get two values: a Client ID and a Consumer Key. The Consumer Key works like a password to your brokerage data: store both right away as described in section 6.
10. Send both to Andres through the private channel he gives you (section 6), never through the sign-up form, email, or a chat app's group.

Cost: SnapTrade says Personal users are currently free. Finnbot adds no charge.

2.2 Option B: Google Sheets (type your holdings in a spreadsheet)

What it is: you keep a Google Sheet listing your holdings, and Finnbot reads it at every digest and watchdog check. Live prices, company names, and exchange rates come from Yahoo Finance automatically; you only enter what you own and what you paid.

Pros:

- Works with any brokerage, or several brokerages at once.
- Nothing is connected to your brokerage account.
- Full control over what Finnbot sees.

Cons:

- Manual: after every buy or sell you must update the sheet, or Finnbot reviews old positions.
- The layout must be exact (below), or rows are skipped or misread.
- Only the exchanges listed below are fully supported.

Steps:

1. Create a new Google Sheet (sheets.google.com, then Blank).
2. On the FIRST tab (the one the spreadsheet was created with), type the column names below in row 1, exactly as written: lowercase, with underscores.
3. Add one row per position, starting in row 2.
4. Share the sheet with Finnbot only: click Share, paste Finnbot's service-account email address (finnbot-service@finnbot-504921.iam.gserviceaccount.com), set it to "Viewer", untick "Notify people", and click Share. Only you and Finnbot can see the sheet. (Don't use "Anyone with the link": then anyone who gets the link can see your holdings.)
5. Send Andres the sheet's ID, PRIVATELY with your keys (section 6.3); the sign-up form doesn't ask for it. It is the long code in the sheet's web address between /d/ and /edit. You can't start until Finnbot has it: until then your answers wait, and you're switched on at the first hourly check after it's in (section 5).

THE COLUMNS (row 1)

Column name	Required?	What to put in it
symbol	Yes	The stock's symbol as Yahoo Finance writes it.
shares_qty	Yes	How many shares you own. Fractions are fine (0.75, 312.4567).
avg_purchase_price	Yes	Your average price PER SHARE, in the currency the stock trades in (see below). 0 or blank means "unknown": the stock is still tracked, but its gain or loss shows as unknown.
account_name	No	Which account it's in, e.g. TFSA, RRSP, ISA, Margin. Shown on the

Column name	Required?	What to put in it
		stock's card and used to total each account.
currency	No	Leave blank (recommended): Finnbot detects it. If you fill it in, use a 3-letter code: USD, CAD, EUR, GBP, AUD, COP.

Any other column (for example "notes") is ignored, so you can keep your own notes beside them.

SYMBOLS

- US stocks and ETFs: the plain symbol: AAPL, MSFT, VOO.
- Share classes use a hyphen, not a dot: BRK-B (not BRK.B).
- Other exchanges add a suffix after a dot:
    1. Toronto (TSX, Venture, NEO, CSE): .TO, .V, .NE, .CN (CAD)
    2. London: .L (GBP, priced in pence)
    3. Australia: .AX (AUD)
    4. Colombia: .CL (COP)
    5. Germany (Xetra, Frankfurt): .DE, .F (EUR)
    6. Paris, Amsterdam, Milan, Madrid: .PA, .AS, .MI, .MC (EUR)
    7. Brussels, Lisbon, Vienna, Helsinki, Dublin: .BR, .LS, .VI, .HE, .IR (EUR)
    - Examples: SHOP.TO, RY.TO, SHEL.L, BHP.AX, SAP.DE, ASML.AS, CIBEST.CL.
    - Exchanges not listed (for example Switzerland's .SW) may load, but their daily changes and currency handling aren't fully supported.

PRICES

- **Enter avg_purchase_price in the currency the stock trades in: US dollars for AAPL, Canadian dollars for SHOP.TO, euros for SAP.DE, pesos for CIBEST.CL.**
- London stocks (.L) are priced in PENCE. A share bought at £34.00 is 3400. Leave the currency column blank for London stocks: writing GBP there makes them 100 times too large.
- Type plain numbers: 3400 or 185.50. No currency symbols ($, £), no thousands separators (72,000), no spaces. Leave the cells' format as Automatic or plain Number: Google may pass a formatted value like "72,000" to Finnbot as text, which would be read as unknown.

SPECIAL CASES

- **The same stock in several accounts: one row per account. Finnbot combines them on one card (total shares, combined gain or loss) and lists the accounts.**
- Several purchases in the same account: either one row with your average price, or one row per purchase. Both give the same totals.
- The same company on two exchanges (for example SHOP and SHOP.TO): two separate rows and two separate cards, since they trade separately.
- Sold a position completely? Delete its row (don't leave it with 0 shares).
- Don't leave empty rows in the middle of the list.

EXAMPLE (row 1 is the column names)

symbol	shares_qty	avg_purchase_price	account_name	currency
AAPL	15	185.00	TFSA	
AAPL	8	362.00	Margin	
BRK-B	12	455.00	RRSP	
SHOP.TO	35	150.00	TFSA	
SHEL.L	120	3400	ISA	
SAP.DE	15	255.00	Brokerage	
BHP.AX	150	44.00	Brokerage	
CIBEST.CL	40	72000	Brokerage	

2.3 Option C: Ideas only (no holdings)

What it is: you get the shared parts of the digest (market signals, macro news, swing and long-term ideas) without connecting any holdings.

Pros: no setup beyond section 1, no API keys, no cost to you.

Cons: no portfolio overview, no reviews of your stocks, no holdings news, no

Telegram alerts or earnings reminders.

If you choose this, skip to section 4. A timezone (3.2) is optional; it only sets whether the email says good morning, afternoon, or evening.

Every digest shows up to 3 long-term and 5 swing ideas (section 8). Want more or fewer? Ask Andres for anywhere from 1 to 10 of each; this applies to every user, with holdings or not.

3. SETTINGS FOR USERS WITH HOLDINGS (OPTIONS A AND B)

3.1 Brokerage name

What it is: a label shown on your overview, for example "Questrade · 3 accounts · 12 positions".

Required: yes. For a Google Sheet, use whatever name you like ("My portfolio", your broker's name).

3.2 Timezone

What it is: your local timezone, used to greet you by your time of day and to show when the digest was prepared in your time as well as New York's.

Required: yes with holdings (optional for ideas only).

Format: a city-based timezone name, for example America/Toronto, America/New_York, America/Bogota, Europe/London, Europe/Madrid, Australia/Perth, Australia/Sydney.

3.3 Home currency

What it is: the currency you think in. Finnbot converts your whole portfolio into it at the top of the email: the total value, the day's change, the unrealized gain or loss, each account's value, and the amounts in the portfolio-risk notes.

Options: USD (default), CAD, EUR, GBP, AUD, COP.

What else you see: when it isn't USD, a line under the total shows the value in US dollars, the exchange rate, and how your currency moved against the dollar this week, e.g. "$108,503.66 USD · 1 GBP = 1.339 USD · GBP +1.0% this week".

Each holding's card stays in the stock's own currency (a Toronto stock in C$, a London stock in £ with its price in pence). The ideas are always in USD, since they're US stocks.

Cost: none.

3.4 The AI model that reviews your holdings

What it is: at every digest, an AI model reviews each of your holdings: its price trend, technical indicators, fundamentals, upcoming earnings, analyst views, and recent news. It then gives the stock one of the five signals (section 0) with its reasoning. The watchdog (3.9) uses the same model when it re-checks a stock.

Nothing to choose: you don't pick a model. Every user's holdings are reviewed by Claude

Haiku 5.5, from Anthropic, at low effort, and the same model writes your portfolio review.

Which key you need: an Anthropic key (3.6).

Cost: about $0.002 per stock, per review.

Why Haiku: in October 2026 Andres compared ten AI models and effort levels on the same holdings, against the strongest available (Claude Opus 5.5). With Finnbot's review rules, Haiku gave the same signal as Opus for about 9 holdings in 10, for about a fortieth of the price, and your holdings data stays with Anthropic. No model's signals are a guarantee.

3.6 API keys (Anthropic, Gemini)

3.5 Effort level

What it is: how long the model "thinks" before answering.

Nothing to choose: low, for everyone, as tested in 3.4. It is already included in the cost in 3.4.

3.6 API keys (Anthropic, Gemini)

What they are: an API key is a private code that lets Finnbot use an AI provider on your account, so the provider bills you directly for your holdings' reviews. You need:

Key	When you need it	Used for
Anthropic	Always, with holdings	Reviewing each holding, and the portfolio review
Gemini	With holdings and news on (3.7)	News for each holding (billing on)

Key	When you need it	Used for

Before you start: have a safe place ready to store each key the moment you create it (section 6). Anthropic shows a key only once; if you lose it, you have to create a new one.

GETTING AN ANTHROPIC KEY (everyone with holdings)

1. **Go to platform.claude.com and sign in, or click to create an account (email or Google sign-in). This is Anthropic's developer console, separate from a claude.ai chat subscription: a Claude Pro or Max plan does NOT include API use.**
2. Add credit: open Billing (in Settings), add a payment card, and buy prepaid credit. For 10 holdings, the Anthropic part is about $1 a month (3.10), so $5 lasts months.
3. Recommended: in the console's limits settings, set a monthly spend limit, so a mistake or a leaked key can never cost more than you chose.
4. Open Settings, then API keys, and click "Create key".
    - - Name: Finnbot
    - - Expiration: none, or a date you'll remember to renew (an expired key stops your reviews until you send a new one)
    - - Linked account: yourself
5. Copy the key (it starts with sk-ant-) and save it immediately in your password manager. The console never shows it again.

GETTING A GEMINI KEY (only if you want news for each holding, 3.7)

1. **Go to the Google AI Studio API Keys page and sign in with a Google account.**
2. Click "Create API key". Choose an existing Google Cloud project or let it create one (any name is fine, e.g. Finnbot).
3. Turn on billing for that project: go to console.cloud.google.com, open Billing, and attach a payment card to the key's project. This is required: Google's free tier doesn't include the web search the news uses, so a key without billing gets no news at all.
4. Recommended: in Billing, set a budget alert, so you're emailed if costs rise.
5. Copy the key (it usually starts with AIza) and save it in your password manager. Cost: about $0.27 a month for 10 holdings and $0.53 for 20, with both digests (3.10). Each key also gets 5,000 free web searches a month, far more than Finnbot uses, so you pay only for the text the model writes.

Tips for both:

- Create a key used ONLY for Finnbot. If it ever leaks, you can delete it without affecting anything else you use the provider for.
- Check your usage page after the first week to confirm costs match section 3.10.
- If a key stops working (expired, out of credit), the top of your email says so, and the rest of your digest still arrives. Create a new key or top up, and send Andres the new key.

3.7 News for each holding

What it is: for each holding, Gemini searches the web for its most important recent news and writes up to 2 short summaries (medium priority or higher), each with a link to its source. They appear on the stock's card and feed the portfolio review.

Options: on (default) or off.

Cost: about $0.001 per stock for a digest's news (Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite, chosen in October 2026 after a comparison of four models: about half the cost of the next-best, with news close to its quality). The Post-Market digest shows the morning's news again for stocks that haven't moved much, kept their signal, and haven't reported earnings since, so most of its news costs nothing.

How much you see: with up to 10 holdings, each card shows up to 2 stories. With more, each shows its single most important story, except stocks flagged risky or urgent sell, which keep 2. This keeps the email under Gmail's size limit.

Pros (on): explains WHY a stock is moving, with sources; the reviews can weigh real events.

Cons (on): needs a Gemini key with billing on; costs a little.

Turning it off means you don't need a Gemini key at all.

Note: Google has announced that this model's prices double on January 1, 2027. That doubles

the news cost with billing on; the free tier stays free.

3.8 Telegram

What it is: Telegram is a free messaging app. Finnbot's Telegram bot sends you:

- Urgent sell alerts, at most once per stock per day. Every digest sends its own as soon as it's out (about 7:35 AM and 4:35 PM ET), and with the watchdog (3.9) they can also come at any time between digests.
- If you buy a stock from one of Finnbot's swing ideas (by the end of the next trading day), an alert when it reaches the idea's stop or target, and a monthly scorecard of how the ideas you bought did against the S&P 500. (Section 9 explains how Finnbot notices the purchase.)
- Earnings reminders: about 24 hours before a stock you hold reports earnings, once per report, with Finnbot's latest call on it.
- Notices when your holdings can't be read, for example the sheet isn't shared with Finnbot or your brokerage connection expired. (Problems with an API key show in the email instead.)

Only the sell alerts and the stop or target alerts are marked urgent.

Your three choices in the form:

- Yes, with the watchdog: everything above, at any time from 4:00 AM to 8:00 PM ET on trading days. The watchdog also takes a closer look around earnings: in the 7 days before a report and on the trading day after it.
- Yes, without the watchdog: everything above, but urgent sells and stop or target alerts come only right after each digest. A problem that appears at 11 AM reaches you after the 4:10 PM digest.
- No Telegram: nothing by Telegram, and no watchdog or tripwire. Urgent sells and holdings problems appear only in the email.

Required: no. Telegram is only for users with holdings.

Only the sell alerts and the stop or target alerts are marked urgent.

Cost: free.

Steps:

1. Install Telegram (phone or desktop) and create an account.
2. Open Finnbot's bot (Andres will send you the link) and press Start. A bot can't message you until you've done this.
3. Find your chat ID: send any message to @userinfobot in Telegram; it replies with your ID, a number like 123456789. (Or tell Andres once you've pressed Start, and he can find it.)
4. Send Andres the number.

3.9 The watchdog: how often, when, and the tripwire

What it is: Every digest already reviews all your holdings and sends any urgent sell right away on Telegram (3.8). The watchdog covers the hours between digests.

Your choice: only on or off ("Yes, with the watchdog" in the form). It runs with the standard settings below: every 4 hours, extended hours, tripwire on. You can change any of them by asking Andres; the options are listed under each, and section 5 lists everything else you can change.

- the price moved about one average day's range since the stock's last review, or
- it reports earnings within 4 trading days, or reported in the last trading day (the day the market reacts to a report released after the close) or
- its last review is more than 24 hours old.

Every other stock keeps its latest signal. There is also a hard cap of 40 AI reviews per day for your watchdog, whatever happens.

A) How often (hours between checks)

Standard: every 4 hours. Other options: 1 to 168 hours, or 0 (off).

- 1 hour: Fastest reaction to news. More checks, so more reviews (still capped).
- 4 hours: The standard: about 3-4 checks across a trading day's extended hours.

The clock counts from the last check or digest, and a check that would land within about 1.5 hours of a digest is skipped, since the digest reviews everything anyway. One more check runs shortly before the 4:00 PM close.
- 24 hours: One check a day.

B) When it runs (session)

- Extended (standard): 4:00 AM-8:00 PM ET on trading days, including pre-market and after-hours, when many companies release earnings. Outside regular hours it uses the pre-market or after-hours price.
- Regular: 9:30 AM-4:00 PM ET on trading days (shorter on half-days). Fewer checks, so a little less cost, but it misses earnings news that lands before the open or after the close until the next check.
- Around the clock: Every hour, every day, weekends and holidays included. Stocks barely trade then, so this mostly adds checks without adding much.

C) The tripwire

What it is: a quick price check every hour between scheduled checks. If a stock moves about twice its average daily range, it gets an AI review right away instead of waiting for the next scheduled check. It pauses for the hour after a digest, which has just reviewed everything.

Standard: on. Other option: off.

Cost: nothing unless a big move triggers a review.

Watchdog cost per month (21 trading days). The watchdog hasn't run on a schedule for long enough to measure, so the first two columns are estimates; the last is the hard maximum.

Quiet (~5 reviews/day)	Busy (~12/day)	Maximum (40/day cap)
$0.20	$0.50	$1.70

"Quiet" is roughly 10 holdings with the standard settings on a normal day; more holdings, hourly

checks, earnings season pushes it toward busy, since a reporting stock is reviewed at every check in the week before its report and on the trading day after. Each review costs about $0.0015-0.002 on your Anthropic key. Most checks review nothing: a stock that hasn't moved and was reviewed in the last 24 hours (every digest reviews them all) keeps its signal.

3.10 What it all costs per month

Your bill = digests + watchdog (3.9). Ideas, market signals, and macro news are covered by Andres.

What each digest costs you:

- The AI review: about $0.002 per holding (Claude Haiku 5.5, 3.4). Anthropic bills it.
- The portfolio review: about $0.0015 per digest, however many holdings you have. Anthropic.
- News, if on: about $0.001 per holding; with both digests, the Post-Market one reuses most of the morning's news (3.7), so its news costs much less. Google bills it.

Estimates for 21 trading days a month. "Per stock per run" is the cost of one digest divided by your number of holdings, the portfolio review included, which is why it falls a little as the portfolio grows.

Digests a day	Holdings	ANTHROPIC (always) per month	GOOGLE (news; only if on, per month)
1	1	$0.07	$0.03
1	10	$0.45	$0.21
1	20	$0.87	$0.42
2	1	$0.15	$0.03

Digests a day	Holdings	ANTHROPIC (always) per month	GOOGLE (news; only if on, per month)
2	10	$0.90	$0.27
2	20	$1.74	$0.53

Then add the watchdog from 3.9 (typically $0.20-0.50 a month for 10 holdings, at most $1.70).

- 10 holdings, news on, both digests, watchdog on: about $0.90 + $0.27 + $0.20 = roughly **$1.40** a month (Anthropic about $1.10, Google $0.27).
- 20 holdings, news on, both digests, watchdog on: about $1.74 + $0.53 + $0.20-0.50 = roughly **$2.50-2.75** a month; at most about $4 if the watchdog hits its daily cap every day.

4. WHICH CHOICES MAKE OTHER SETTINGS UNNECESSARY

If you choose...	You can skip...
Ideas only (2.3)	All of section 3: brokerage name, home currency, model, effort, every API key, news, Telegram, watchdog. Timezone is optional.
SnapTrade (2.1)	The Google Sheet and its ID.
Google Sheets (2.2)	The SnapTrade Client ID and Consumer Key.
No Telegram	The chat ID, and the watchdog (it can't run without Telegram).
News off (3.7)	The Gemini key.
Telegram without the watchdog	Nothing extra: you still send the chat ID.

If you choose...	You can skip...
Any watchdog setting	Nothing: the standard settings (3.9) apply unless you ask Andres for others.
Home currency USD	Nothing extra; it's the default.

Things that are still needed even though you might expect otherwise:

- Google Sheets: the sheet's ID, sent privately (the form doesn't ask for it).
- News on: a Gemini key with billing turned on.

5. WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOU SEND YOUR ANSWERS, AND WHAT YOU CAN CHANGE LATER

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1. Finnbot reads the form's answers every hour and saves your settings. Andres gets a message listing anything still missing (your keys, chat ID, or sheet ID).
2. Andres enters what you sent him privately.
3. At the next hourly check after nothing is missing, you're switched on automatically, and Andres is told. Ideas-only users have nothing to send, so they're on within the hour.
4. Your first digest arrives at the next scheduled time on a trading day: 7:00 AM or 4:10 PM New York time, about 20-30 minutes after it starts. A digest already being built when you're switched on doesn't include you.
5. If something goes wrong later (a key runs out, a connection expires, the sheet can't be read), the top of your email tells you what happened (sheet and brokerage problems also come by Telegram) and says "Contact Andres to address this issue." Andres is the only admin.

WHAT YOU CAN CHANGE, AND HOW

Setting	Standard	Your options	How
Digests	(your answer)	Both, Pre-Market, or Post-Market only	The form
How Finnbot sees your holdings	(your answer)	SnapTrade, Google Sheet, or ideas only	The form
Brokerage name	(your answer)	Any label	The form
Timezone	(your answer)	Any city-based name (3.2)	The form
Home currency	USD	USD, CAD, EUR, GBP, AUD, COP	The form
News for each holding	On	On or off	The form
Telegram	(your answer)	With the watchdog, without it, or none	The form
Watchdog: hours between checks	4	1 to 168, or 0 (off)	Ask Andres
Watchdog: session	Extended	Regular, extended, or around the clock (3.9)	Ask Andres
Watchdog: tripwire	On	On or off	Ask Andres
Watchdog: extra checks after an earnings report	1 trading day	0 or more	Ask Andres
Long-term ideas per digest	3	1 to 10	Ask Andres
Swing ideas per digest	5	1 to 10	Ask Andres

And more on request: if there's something else you'd like Finnbot to do differently for you, ask Andres. Much of Finnbot can be adjusted, and good suggestions may become an option for everyone.

- **Through the form:** fill it in again with the same first name and email. Your newest answer

replaces the old one at the next hourly check. If the new choice needs something new (for example a Gemini key when you turn news on, or a sheet ID when you switch to Google Sheets), your digests pause until Andres has entered it, so send it to him privately before you send the new answer.

- **Through Andres:** message him. Changes apply from the next run.
- **To stop Finnbot altogether,** tell Andres.

6. KEEPING YOUR KEYS AND DATA SAFE

6.1 Why an API key matters

An API key is like a password and a credit card in one. Anyone who has your key can:

- **Anthropic and Gemini keys:** run as many AI requests as they like, billed to YOU, until your credit or spend limit runs out. Leaked keys are found and abused within minutes; there are automated programs that search the internet for them all day.
- **SnapTrade Consumer Key:** read all of your brokerage positions and balances, and possibly place trades where trading is enabled.

The providers can't tell a thief's requests from yours, and generally won't refund them.

6.2 Store every key safely the moment you create it

Anthropic and SnapTrade show a key only once. If you don't save it right away, you'll have to create a new one.

- **Best:** a password manager (for example Bitwarden, 1Password, or the one built into your iPhone, Android, or browser). Save each key as its own entry,

e.g. "Finnbot - Anthropic key", with the date you created it.
- **Acceptable:** a note on your own device that's locked with a passcode, or an encrypted file.
- **Not safe:** a plain text file in a shared or synced folder, an email to yourself, a photo or screenshot, a sticky note, a shared document, or any chat message you send to yourself.

Keep your copy even after you've sent it to Andres: you'll need it to check usage, and you can recognise which key is yours if you ever have to delete it.

6.3 Be very careful how keys travel online

Every place a key is pasted is a place it can leak from. Never put a key in:

- The Finnbot sign-up form (it asks you NOT to; its answers are stored in a spreadsheet).
- A group chat, a public post, a forum, a comment, or a support ticket.
- An ordinary email or text message (they're stored in plain text on several servers and backed up indefinitely).
- A screenshot or screen share (images of keys are read by the same automated programs).
- A shared document or spreadsheet, or a code repository (for example GitHub).
- An AI chatbot or assistant.

How to send your keys to Andres:

- Only through the private channel Andres tells you to use, for example an end-to-end encrypted messenger such as Signal, or your password manager's secure-sharing feature.
- Send them directly to Andres, one-to-one. Never to a group, even a private one.
- Double-check the recipient before you send.
- Delete the message on your side once Andres confirms he has them.
- Never send a key to anyone who asks for it "on behalf of Finnbot": Andres will never ask you to send keys anywhere else, and nobody else is entitled to them.

6.4 Limit the damage in advance

- Create a key used only for Finnbot, so you can delete it without affecting anything else.
- Set a monthly spend limit (Anthropic) or a budget alert (Google), so a leak can never cost much.
- Turn on two-factor authentication for each provider account and for SnapTrade.
- Look at each provider's usage page now and then. Usage you don't recognise is the first sign of a leak.

6.5 If you think a key has leaked

1. Delete (revoke) it immediately on the provider's website: the key stops working at once.
2. Create a new key and save it safely (6.2).
3. Send the new key to Andres privately (6.3) and tell him what happened.
4. Check the provider's usage and billing pages for charges you don't recognise, and contact the provider's support if you find any.

6.6 Where your data goes

- Your holdings (symbols, share counts, prices paid) are sent to Anthropic, whose AI model reviews them and writes the portfolio review (with your account names). Gemini's news searches use only the symbols and company names; on the free tier, Google may use those to improve its products.
- With SnapTrade, SnapTrade can read your brokerage positions.
- With Google Sheets, only you, Finnbot's service account, and anyone you shared the sheet with can see it.
- Andres sees your settings and keys in order to run Finnbot for you, and never shares them.

7. CHECKLIST: WHAT TO SEND ANDRES

Most answers go in Finnbot's sign-up form. Everything marked (PRIVATELY) never goes in the form: get it ready first, then send it through the private channel Andres gives you (section 6.3).

Everyone (in the form):

- [ ] Your first name
- [ ] Your email address
- [ ] Which digests: both, Pre-Market only, or Post-Market only
- [ ] Holdings: link your brokerage (SnapTrade), a Google Sheet, or no holdings
- [ ] Gmail: allow Finnbot's dynamic email (1.4), so the dropdowns work (not in the form)

SnapTrade only:

- [ ] SnapTrade Client ID and Consumer Key (PRIVATELY)

Google Sheets only:

- [ ] The sheet, shared with Finnbot's service account
- [ ] The sheet's ID (PRIVATELY)

With holdings (SnapTrade or Google Sheets), in the form:

- [ ] Brokerage name (any label for a sheet)
- [ ] Timezone, e.g. America/Toronto
- [ ] Home currency: USD, CAD, EUR, GBP, AUD, or COP (default USD)
- [ ] Anthropic key (PRIVATELY)
- [ ] Telegram: with the watchdog, without it, or none (3.8)

And sent PRIVATELY:

- [ ] Anthropic key
- [ ] Gemini key (only with news on; billing turned on for its project)
- [ ] Telegram chat ID (only if you chose Telegram)

Ideas only, optionally (in the form):

- [ ] Timezone, for the greeting

Both lists start every digest from the same place: every US-listed stock (NYSE, Nasdaq, NYSE American) that is large (currently $9 billion in market value and up), trades at least 1 million shares a day, and costs at least $30 a share. That is about 600 stocks. Two screens then narrow them down, the survivors are scored by an AI model, and the best scores become the ideas. The scoring model is DeepSeek V4.1 Flash, chosen in a comparison against stronger models; Andres pays for it.

How many: up to 3 long-term and 5 swing ideas per digest; ask Andres for anywhere from 1 to 10 of each. A day with fewer stocks above the pass mark shows fewer.

"Different industries" below uses Yahoo Finance's industries (about 140, such as

Semiconductors or Regional Banks), so two Technology stocks that do different things can both be picked. "Tech" means the Technology and Communication Services sectors.

8.1 Long-term ideas: businesses worth owning for years

1. Quality screen (Yahoo Finance): at least 8 analysts follow it and their average rating leans Buy (2.4 or better, on a scale where 1 is Strong Buy and 3 is Hold); expected to be profitable over the next year, at a forward P/E of 35 or less; a net profit margin of at least 7%; revenue up at least 5% on a year ago; a return on equity of at least 12%.
2. Confirmation (Finnhub, over the last 12 months): revenue up at least 9%, earnings per share growing, debt at most 1.75 times equity, and a P/E between 0 and 65.
3. Not overheated: a trend-strength reading (ADX) of 45 or less. About 100 stocks usually get this far; the 35 that rate best on the scoring's own measures go on to be scored.
4. Scoring: the model scores each one out of 100 on valuation, financial health, growth, and competitive advantage (its "moat"). A score within 5 points of the pass mark is scored twice more and the middle score kept, so one unlucky run can't decide a close call.
5. Picking: ideas scoring 85 or more, highest first, each from a different industry. At least a third of the list, rounded up, is outside tech (1 of 3), and those may score from 80. These mix rules only choose between stocks: if they'd leave the list short, it's filled with the best of the stocks they left out. On a day few stocks reach 85, the list is shorter.

Each card shows the score and its four parts, the model's thesis and key risk, the forward P/E, PEG, revenue growth, profit margin, and two momentum readings: RSI (overbought at 70+, oversold at 30 or less) and the 12-month price return.

8.2 Swing ideas: trades over the next few weeks

1. A looser quality screen: at least 3 analysts, a consensus of Hold or better, profitable now and expected to stay so (forward P/E up to 60), and revenue at most 5% below a year ago.
2. A setup in the daily prices, one of two kinds:
    - - A pullback: at least 1.5 normal days' ranges (ATR) below its recent high, but not more than 30% down, and at most 5% below its 200-day average, so the longer trend is intact.
    - - A new uptrend: its 9-day average crossed above its 21-day average in the last 5 sessions.

Either way: at least $10 a share and $20 million traded a day, an RSI between 20 and 65, not still falling, and no earnings report within 5 trading days.

3. A trade plan worked out by Finnbot itself, the same way for every stock: the stop just under the nearest support (and at least 1.5 normal days' ranges below the entry), the target at the nearest resistance above it (a recent high, a moving average, or the upper Bollinger Band), 1.5 to 8 ranges up. A plan with less than 1.5 times as much to gain as to lose is dropped. The best 40 plans go on to scoring.
4. Scoring: the model scores out of 100 on the technical setup, the plan's reward against its risk (worked out by Finnbot, not the model), momentum and volume, and catalysts and sentiment. Close calls are scored again, as above.
5. Picking: ideas scoring 75 or more that are still early in their move (not already run up from their recent low, RSI 70 or less, not above the upper Bollinger Band), with more than half of them from different industries, and at least 1 outside tech in a list of 4 or more (2 in a list of 8 or more). As above, a list the mix rules would leave short is filled with the best of the rest.

Each card shows the plan (entry, stop, target, and the ratio of gain to risk), what the stop and target are based on, and the technical readings behind the setup.

Both lists are US stocks, priced in US dollars. They are AI-scored ideas from public data, not advice: always do your own research before buying.

9. HOW FINNBOT ASSESSES YOUR HOLDINGS

At every digest (and at each watchdog check, 3.9), each of your holdings gets one of the five signals (section 0) and a short reason, from Claude Haiku 5.5 on your Anthropic key.

9.1 What the model sees, per holding

- The price path: the last 21 daily prices and volumes, and technical indicators (RSI, 9- and 21-day averages, Bollinger Bands, Parabolic SAR, beta).
- The business: fundamentals, analysts' ratings and targets, insider buying and selling, recent headlines, the next earnings date, and past earnings surprises.
- Your position: shares, what you paid, the gain or loss, and its share of your portfolio.
- If you bought it from a Finnbot swing idea: the idea's plan (entry, stop, target).

9.2 Facts worked out first, by Finnbot itself

So that every review reads the chart the same way, Finnbot computes these before the model sees the stock, and the model applies them as given:

- The long-term trend: intact (above its 200-day average, with the 50-day above the 200-day), mixed, or weak.
- A pullback (at least 1.5 normal days' ranges below its 20-day high), or a recent run (up 15% or more, or 4 ranges, from its 20-day low).
- Signs the selling is ending (0 to 4): RSI rising, heavier volume on up days, a higher low, and a close above its 9-day average (or its stop-and-reverse level below the price).
- Stretched (RSI 70+ or above the upper Bollinger Band), trading days to the next earnings report, and whether it's a fund or a leveraged ETF.

9.3 The rules, checked in this order (the first that applies wins)

1. Urgent sell: a specific, recent event that can't wait for the next digest, such as fraud, bankruptcy risk, a guidance collapse, or a failed key product; or a sharp breakdown through support on heavy volume. Never for slow drift, valuation alone, or a normal-sized move.
2. Profit sell: a real recent run plus at least two signs it's tiring (stretched, RSI falling from a high, at the analysts' target or a prior high, momentum fading, or valuation stretched).
3. Risky: one serious warning (missed earnings twice or cut guidance, two analyst downgrades, news that damages the reason to own it, or a broken trend that's still falling), or two lesser ones (a short-term downtrend with no sign of a turn, earnings within about 5 trading days, one downgrade, heavy insider selling, shrinking margins, an unexplained move twice its normal size). An upcoming earnings report alone is not enough.
4. Buy more: a pullback in an intact or mixed long-term trend, with at least 2 of the 4 signs the selling is ending, not stretched, no warning from rule 3, and the business unchanged.
5. Hold: everything else.

Funds and ETFs (leveraged ones included) are judged on their price trend alone, since they have no earnings or analysts of their own.

Note: buy more means "it dipped, and now is a good time to add". A stock you just bought from a swing idea that started a new uptrend usually shows hold: keep it, and follow the idea's plan.

9.4 Second looks

An urgent sell or profit sell is reviewed twice more, and the majority wins (the milder signal on a tie), so a one-off reading can't send you an alert. The model also rates its overall outlook on the stock (bullish, neutral, or bearish), separately from the signal.

9.5 The rest of the holdings section

- News (3.7): up to 2 stories per holding from Gemini, with links, shown on its card.
- The portfolio review: up to 5 notes on the portfolio as a whole (concentration in a stock, sector, or currency; stocks likely to move together; overall market sensitivity; earnings dates close together; how much is flagged risky), written by Claude Haiku from the figures in your digest.
- Reuse: a review the watchdog made in the last hour, for a stock that hasn't moved since, is reused instead of asking the model again.
- Bought from an idea: Finnbot notices a new position in a stock it suggested the day before (by the end of the next trading day), labels its card with the idea, gives the model the idea's plan, and sends the alerts in 3.8.